

Rejecting Liberalism

Chapter 7

Chapter Issue:

- ✦ To what extent is communism or fascism a valid response to liberalism?

Key Terms

- Bolsheviks
- Communism
- Dictatorship
- Dissent
- Eugenics
- Fascism
- Leninism
- Nazism
- Social Darwinism
- Stalinism
- Subsistence Agriculture

Use this chart to help you consider the relationships between the ideologies based on the values of collectivism



How was communism in the Soviet Union a rejection of liberalism?

Understandings of Communism

- Karl Marx believed that, through revolution, people could move closer to a state of society called *Communism*.
- *Collective more important than the individual*
- One key way that communism varies from democratic socialism is that communism values revolutionary change over gradual change



- During the 20th century different forms of communism developed:
 - Marxism-Leninism (Soviet Union)
 - Stalinism (Soviet Union)
 - Maoism (China)
- All are defined by the different leaders, how they interpret Marxism, and how they apply them
- Some however, see communism and Marxism as the same

Some key Ideas of Communist Theory

Political Ideas	Economic Ideas	Social Ideas
Workers revolt and overthrow the wealthy business owners and landowners	There will be collective ownership of the means of production (resources, land, capital)	A classless society will be created
The state will be governed by the Communist Party in the interests of the people	Private property will be abolished	Women will have equal rights
The political structure will have less hierarchy	Incomes will be equalized	There will be cooperation instead of competition
there will be a more collective form of government with better representation for all people		

Russian Revolution and the Beginning of Communism in the Soviet Union

Failure of Liberal Reform

- 1800's- Russia less industrialized than Western Europe, slow to develop, poverty widespread
 - Russia lead by a *Czar*
 - no basic rights for *serfs* like there was in other countries yet, essentially enslaved to landowners
- 1861- Czar Alexander II freed the serfs and introduced liberal reforms
 - Abolished capital punishment, created local governments with representatives who made decisions on taxation and education



The major contributor to this was that Russian farmers practiced **subsistence farming** (farming just enough to survive)

The Russian serfs were essentially slaves to the landowners they worked for.

- Revolutionary socialist groups not happy- they wanted immediate change
- 1881- Czar Alexander II assassinated after multiple attempts,
- Reforms reversed, and freedoms restricted by Czar Alexander III



The Rise Of Socialism

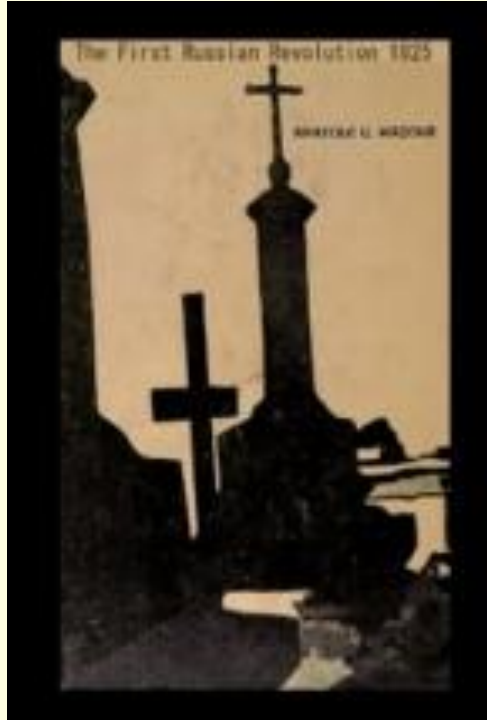


- 1800's- foreign investment in Russia, late in the Industrial Revolution
 - Social and Economic boom
 - Gap in distribution of wealth
- 1898-Marxist thinkers form Socialist Democratic Labour Party (SDLP)
- Party banned, and members were exiled
- kept their momentum by publishing illegal newspaper
- Members included Vladimir Lenin, Leon Trotsky, and Joseph Stalin



- Despite the exile of socialist activists, unrest grew
- 1905- people of St. Petersburg march on palace for better working conditions and food
- Czar's soldiers open fire on crowd at palace gate's
- Became known as *Bloody Sunday*
- Strikes followed
- Czar Nicholas II allowed an assembly of the people's representatives, who encouraged further strikes and for people to not pay their taxes
- October Manifesto signed, allowing formation of political parties, basic civil rights, and freedoms of speech and religion
- This first Russian Revolution set the stage for the growth of socialism, and the Revolution of 1917

The Rise of Socialism (Pg 164)



- The events of 1905 were eventually named The First Russian Revolution
- This increased the popularity of Socialism in Russia.

Revolution of 1917

- As a result of the revolution and the forced abdication of Czar Nicholas II , Russia was without a leader in the last few years of WWI
- A temporary liberal democratic government was established, but failed due to lack of support as it chose to keep fighting in the war, rather than help it's poorest citizens
- Support for communist and Marxist ideas grew.

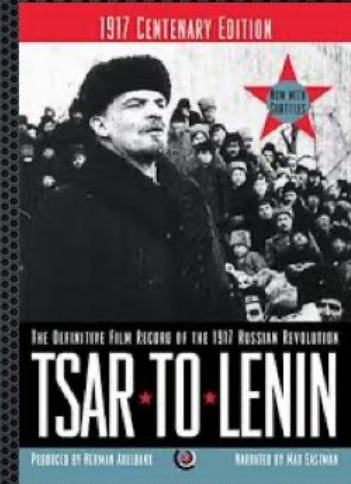
- April 1917- Vladimir Lenin , founder and leader of the **Bolsheviks** called for an end of participation in the war.
- It's slogan "Peace! Land! Bread!" gained popularity as it is what the peasants and working class had been wanting for years.
- October 1917- Leon Trotsky joined Lenin and they were successful in creating a new government.
- Leninism, a form of communism, developed
 - similar to communism- revolution and violence acceptable
 - different from communism-believed government necessary





- 1918- Lenin shot in assassination attempt
- Lenin retaliated with Red Terror, many people tortured and executed
- Civil War erupted between Bolshevik Red Army and Anti-Bolshevik White Army
 - White Army supported by anti-communist countries such as US, Canada, France, Britain
 - White Army defeated, most executed or exiled

- 1922- Union of Soviet Socialist Republic created (USSR) (refer to pg. 165 for the shifts in name)
 - Lead by Lenin
- Positive changes followed
 - New Economic Policy (introduce limited capitalism)
 - creation of rich peasant class called kulaks
 - Land redistributed to people
 - Factories given to workers to make decisions on wage, working conditions
 - Men and women equal and valuable to society
 - Art and Music flourished due to lack of restrictions



- Lenin's application of Marxist values had given poor and working class power over their lives vs. czarist rule
- Some did not feel represented however
- Some political turmoil, famine and violence from Lenin to non-supporters
- Lenin died of stroke in 1924, end of Leninist rule
- Sum up Lenin



Stalinism

- Following Lenin's death, there was a struggle for power between Trotsky and Stalin
- Trotsky was an ally of Lenin, both opposed Stalin taking power.
- 1928-Stalin leader, Trotsky removed from the Communist Party, exiled and finally assassinated in Mexico

- Stalin claimed to be a Marxist-Leninist, but desired to maintain absolute power and control
- Use of oppression and fear rather than revolution and freedom
- Rejected almost all liberal values



Some examples of his policies include:

- Creation of the Gulag (prison camp) System to contain those who opposed to his views
- The use of secret police (NKVD) to control people through terror and force
- The purges of 1936 in 1939 in which he eliminated his opponents in the Communist Party and the Soviet Armed Forces
- Rewriting history by altering the Soviet archives
- The rapid, forced industrialization of the country
- Collectivization of all farms, private farms were taken by force and used to create a collective farming system



“We must put an end to its backwardness in the shortest possible time... there is no other way. That is why Lenin said on the eve of the October Revolution: ‘either perish, or overtake and outstrip the advanced capitalist countries’

We are 50 or 1 hundred years behind the advanced countries. We must make good this distance in 10 years. Either we do it, or we shall be crushed.”

*—Joseph Stalin
speech to industrial managers*

- Thinking back to the Russian Civil war, why would Stalin have feared Capitalist countries?

Holodomor

- 1932-1933- Severe drought and planned famine due to plans for industrialization, higher agricultural output, and the government ownership of land
- This famine became known as **Holodomor**, and was a result of Stalin's collectivization policies.
- Stolen suppressed Ukrainian nationalism and its opposition to his leadership, require large grain quotas to be filled, withheld stockpiled grain from many, starving 7 to 10 Million people in order to remove resistance from his ideas of collectivization

- In 2008, governments around the world recognize the Holodomor as a crime against humanity and an act of genocide
- To these measures don't transform the Soviet Union into a dictatorship and one of the most industrialized and powerful forces in the world
- Soviet citizens paid a tremendous price for this transformation, Stalin became known as one of the most ruthless leaders of the 20th Century

- Stalin's Rule came to an end in 1953
- Over the next 30 years most of the world was split in two:
 - Those countries allied with the Soviets
 - Those allied with the Americans
- This became known as the Cold War (next chapter)



- In the mid 1980s Mikhail Gorbachev being a leader of the Soviet Union
- First leader in the Soviet Union to embrace the values of liberalism, most notably in his policies of openness and the greater freedoms (known as *glasnost*)
- *Perestroika*- restructuring of political and economic systems: Created a market economy, private ownership of business, democratic reforms and Multi party elections

Techniques of Dictatorships

Censoring the media, for example, writers and artists, and controlling participation

Glorifying the leader and his accomplishments

Rewriting curriculum and textbooks to portray the glory of the nation and the leader

Holding rallies, giving powerful speeches, and creating youth movements to teach “accepted” values

Using propaganda, indoctrination, terror and force

Using The military or police, and violence, to create a climate of fear

Removing leaders or parties that pose a threat to the dictator

Holding elections in which it is impossible for people to vote for anyone else

Techniques of Dictatorships



1. PROPAGANDA AND INDOCTRINATION

Dictators often use **propaganda and indoctrination** to maintain control over the people. Propaganda is the systematic attempt to manipulate public opinions and beliefs, often through the mass media. All media such as television, radio, movies, books, newspapers and even billboards are controlled by the government. Schools and other organisations are used to *indoctrinate* children with the beliefs of the elite. Often young people are organised into nationalist youth groups to promote the ideas of the dictator.

2. USE OF FORCE AND TERROR

Most dictators use **force and terror** to destroy all opposition to their government. Usually there is a secret police that rounds up citizens identified as being enemies of the state. People may be imprisoned, tortured, or killed. The remaining population becomes too afraid to resist the government. The Soviet Union used the NKVD, later renamed the KGB, and Nazi Germany used the Gestapo as their secret police forces.



3. DIRECTION OF POPULAR DISCONTENT or SCAPEGOATING

Dictators frequently take people's concerns and unhappiness and turn it against groups that are blamed for causing the problem. Usually the targeted group is either a minority population in the nation or an outside force, such as another nation. By directing discontent, the dictator hopes all the hatred of the citizens will be focused on the scapegoat and not on the government.



Scapegoat

1: a person or group made to bear the blame for others or to suffer in their place.

4. CONTROLLED PARTICIPATION

Even in dictatorships, people must feel a sense of participation in the political process. Yet, dictators fear giving the people real political power. Often in dictatorships, elections are held even if there is no real choice. If there is a choice, ballot counting allows the government to manipulate the results. In other countries people are allowed to become members of the ruling party so they feel encouraged to work within the system.

